Template access and the five rules of document hygiene

Open an approved template

Start a new document	**File › New › Shared** (or **Custom**) › select the template › **Create**
Never	open an old report and Save As. It brings hidden styles, comments and settings.

The five rules

1. Start from the template	Fresh styles, no hidden history.
2. Style, don't format	Every paragraph gets a style: Heading 1–3, Normal, List Bullet.
3. Paste clean	Ctrl + Shift + V pastes plain text, then apply your styles.
4. Compress pictures	**Picture Format › Compress Pictures**: untick "this picture only", delete cropped areas, 150 ppi.
5. No empty paragraphs	Use **Spacing Before/After** and **Page break before**.

Diagnose first

Show/Hide ¶	Ctrl + Shift + 8
Navigation Pane	Ctrl + F
Reveal Formatting	Shift + F1
Clear manual formatting	Ctrl + Space
Inspect before sharing	**File › Info › Check for Issues › Inspect Document**

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The style hierarchy and one-click TOC

Apply styles

Heading 1	Ctrl + Alt + 1 main sections
Heading 2	Ctrl + Alt + 2 subsections
Heading 3	Ctrl + Alt + 3 detail (use sparingly)
Normal	Ctrl + Shift + N body text
Change every heading	Right-click the style › **Modify**, or **Update Heading 1 to Match Selection**

Restructure

Open the map	**View › Navigation Pane**
Move a section	Drag its heading. Subheadings, tables and pictures move with it.
Change a level	Right-click › **Promote** or **Demote**

Table of contents

Insert	**References › Table of Contents › Automatic Table 1**
Update after edits	Click in the TOC › F9 › **Update entire table**
Only pages moved	**Update page numbers only**
Heading missing?	It isn’t using a Heading style.
Never	type a TOC by hand or use Manual Table.

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Section breaks, unlinking and mixed layouts

Choose the break

Page break	Ctrl + Enter new page, same section
Next Page section break	**Layout › Breaks › Next Page**: new section, new page
Continuous	new section, same page (columns)
Odd/Even Page	double-sided print only; can add blank pages

One landscape page

1	Turn on ¶
2	Next Page break **before** the wide content
3	Next Page break **after** it
4	Click in the middle section › **Layout › Orientation › Landscape**
5	Check footers and numbering

Headers, footers, numbers

Different header in a section	Double-click header › turn off **Link to Previous**
Numbering restarts	**Page Number › Format Page Numbers › Continue from previous section**
No number on cover	**Different First Page**; Start at 0
Blank last page	¶ after a table: set it to 1 pt. Manual break: delete it.

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Tables and media layout quick-fix guide

Tables

Spills off the page	**Table Layout › AutoFit › AutoFit Window**, or a landscape section
Even columns	**Table Layout › Distribute Columns**
Header on every page	Click row 1 › **Table Layout › Repeat Header Rows**
Row splits across pages	**Properties › Row** › untick **Allow row to break across pages**
Alignment	**Table Layout › Alignment**; right-align numbers
Accessibility	One header row, no merged cells, no layout tables

Pictures

Most report images	**In Line with Text**
Small image beside text	**Square** or **Tight**
Large figure	**Top and Bottom**
Avoid	**Behind Text**, **In Front of Text**
Alt text	Right-click › **View Alt Text**; tick **Mark as decorative** for logos

Cover pages

Insert	**Insert › Cover Page** › your organisation’s cover
Fill in	Type into the [placeholders]; don’t delete them
Remove	**Insert › Cover Page › Remove Current Cover Page**

Clean export and share settings

Save and share

Where	OneDrive or SharePoint, not your desktop
Roll back	**File › Info › Version History**
Share	**Share** › choose who the link works for; view-only if editing isn't needed
Before external sharing	**Inspect Document**: remove comments, tracked changes and personal info

Accessible PDF

1. Check	**Review › Check Accessibility**; fix errors
2. Update fields	Ctrl + A then F9
3. Export	**File › Export › Create PDF/XPS**
4. Options	Tick **Create bookmarks using: Headings** and **Document structure tags for accessibility**
5. Open and check	Bookmarks, page order, orientation, numbering

Avoid

Print to PDF	No bookmarks or tags
Email attachments for review	Versions multiply; share a link
Screenshots of text	Unreadable to screen readers and search